DEPCOM POWER
A KOCH ENGINEERED SOLUTIONS BUSINESS

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Glossary of DEPCOM Terms, Acronyms, and Definitions

DEPCOM, like many companies, has a language that is full of terms and acronyms. Many of these terms and acronyms are unique to the PV Solar industry and it is important to familiarize yourself with these items so you can communicate effectively with DEPCOM and Project stakeholders. To assist you with this, DEPCOM has prepared the Glossary below. If you have any acronyms or definitions needing to be added or revised, please utilize the QMS Communications & Change Requests SmartSheet and it will be added to the next version of the DEPCOM Glossary.

Term	Acronym / Abbreviation	Definition
Alternating Current	AC	The type of power used on the power grid, businesses, and residences.
American Land Title Agreement	ALTA	This document indicates property boundaries and known utilities on a property.
Anti-Dumping	AD	The imposition of a tariff on an imported good that is believed to be underpriced.
Array		An individual subset of the PV plant, consisting of all mechanical and electrical components grouped together. Typically consisting of a single PCS, arrays can otherwise vary in size by footprint, quantity of equipment, and electrical capacity.
As-Builts		As-built drawings (also known as "Record Drawings") are the completed and stamped drawing records representing the actual work completed in a project. They are essential as they are used to track approved deviations from the original building plans.
Authority Having Jurisdiction	AHJ	An organization, office, or individual responsible for enforcing the requirements of a code or approving equipment.

Authorized to Execute	ATE	N/A
Automatic Transfer Switch	ATS	A system that automatically transfers power from a primary source to a backup source during power interruptions.
Balance of Systems	BOS	Encompasses all components of a photovoltaic (PV) system outside of modules, mechanical racking and PCS's
Battery Energy Storage System	BESS	The technology responsible for storage of electrical power. DEPCOM typically contracts these projects separately from a PV project.
Best Management Practice	BMP	Methods or techniques that are found to be the most effective and practical means in achieving an objective (e.g., minimizing pollution).
Best Management Practices	BMPs	Methods or techniques used to minimize environmental impacts.
Bill of Materials	BOM	A list generated by engineering which tabulates all required materials and respective quantities for a project. The BOM is then delivered to supply chain to source Contractor furnished materials.
Block/Circuit		Blocks – sometimes referred to as "Circuits" (not to be confused with those referenced in the electrical drawings) – are groups of arrays and/or electrical circuits within an area of a site, adding up to a predetermined amount of MWdc/ac production. The amount of MWdc/ac and size of blocks are determined in the preconstruction phase and depend on factors such as project schedule and client preferences.
Bonfiglioli	Bonfig	Inverter Manufacturer.
Builder's All Risk	BAR	Insurance policy required for all projects. EPC will dictate if Contractor is required to carry it.
Bureau of Land Management	BLM	N/A
Business Development	BD	Activity of pursuing strategic opportunities for a particular business or organization.
Capacity	Cap	Often used as "Cap Test" to check for production after mechanical completion.
Change Order		An amendment in a contract that leads to changes in the scope of work or contract terms and conditions (Ts&Cs), generally resulting in a change to cost and/or schedule.

Combiner Box	CBx/CMBX	Combines the output of several solar strings into a single output.
Commercial Operation Date	COD	The date when a project is substantially complete and begins producing electricity for sale.
Commissioning	Cx	The process of verifying and optimizing photovoltaic system performance.
Conditional Use Permit	CUP	A permit allowing specific land use under predetermined conditions within a zoning district.
Construction Manager	CM	The manager of the construction site.
Construction Start Date	CSD	The date when construction activities begin at a project site.
Conversion Jumper	DC Jumpers	Provides compatibility between PV Module connectors to MC4 connectors
Corrective Action	CA	An action (or steps of a larger plan) required to resolve an issue in response to an unforeseen event.
Countervailing Duties	CVD	An import tax imposed to counteract subsidies provided to foreign exporters.
Current at Max Power	IMP	The current seen by a system under maximum load.
Cut and Fill		The volume of earth either removed ("cut") and/or placed ("fill") to achieve a balanced site topography. Cut and fill is calculated by Civil Engineering during the preconstruction and design phase of a project, considering factors such as stormwater impacts, regulatory constraints, and post/racking tolerances.
Data Acquisition System	DAS	Used in utility-scale solar projects to monitor site conditions and performance.
DC Feeder Cable	DCF	Interconnection wiring between PCS's and combiner boxes (CBx/CMBXs)
DC Homerun Cables	DCHR	Interconnection from string wire to combiner box
Delegation of Authority	DOA	The process to determine decision rights around spending approvals. A matrix, the DOA consists of spending thresholds which require additional layers of approval as dollar-amount being requested increases. The DOA is published by the executive leadership group.
DEPCOM Power Inc.	DPI	N/A

Design Feature Management (Plan)	DFM(P)	N/A
Development Service Agreement	DSA	N/A
Direct Current	DC	The type of power generated by solar PV modules.
Direct Current Isolation Panel	DCIP	N/A
Division of Responsibility	DOR	N/A
Electronic Communications Network	ECN	N/A
Engineer of Record	EOR	The licensed engineer that is responsible for signing off on issued drawings.
Engineering Start Date	ESD	The date when detailed engineering begins.
Engineering, Procurement & Construction	EPC	A contract model that is often used in large-scale projects.
Estimated Completion Date	ECD	N/A
Experience Modification Rate	EMR	A measure that is used to evaluate the safety performance of a company based on past claims data.
Extension Jumper	DC Jumpers	Provides module to module extensions over certain distances or gaps in excess of 6 inches
Factory Acceptance Test	FAT	An equipment vendor deliverable to confirm functionality before shipment.
Factory Witness Test	FWT	Testing performed at the factory for specific equipment types by the manufacturer.
Field Engineer	FE	The resident engineering representative assigned to a construction project.
Final Completion	FC	All punch list items are complete, and all project deliverables have been transmitted to the project owner. In cases where an O&M contract is in place, thesite is turned-over to the O&M team at this time.
Finding of No Significant Impact	FONSI	A decision by a federal agency that a project will not have a significant environmental impact.

First Article Inspection	FAI	The formal inspection process verifying the installation, processes, and procedures of installed components to define what good looks like within a completed product. Every inspection within the ITP is prefaced with an FAI
Fixed Tilt Racking System	FT	A racking style which maintains a constant tilt angle — typically optimized for the site's latitude — to maximize annual sunlight exposure without any mechanical movement.
Footing		A footing is the part of a building's foundation that creates an attachment between the soil and the foundation of the building.
Forecast	FCST	A projection of future performance or outcomes.
Full Notice to Proceed	FNTP	Approval to begin full construction of a project.
Generation and Power Systems Engineering	GPSE	A division within DEPCOM responsible for project development and design.
Generation Sectionalizing Cabinet	GSC	Termination points for underground distribution systems
Generator Step-Up Transformer	GSU	A transformer is used to increase voltage for transmission to the grid.
Ground Cover Ratio	GCR	The ratio of the area covered by solar modules to the total area of the site.
Ground Penetrating Radar	GPR	A method used to determine what is underground before pile testing.
Health and Safety Plan	HASP	A document detailing health and safety requirements and procedures for a project.
Heating, Ventilation, and Air Conditioning	HVAC	A system used for climate control in equipment and buildings.
Independent System Operator	ISO	An organization responsible for grid management and energy market operations.
Inspection Test Plan	ITP	The plan defined by DEPCOM Quality to outline the processes, standards, and stages at which inspections and tests will be conducted to ensure quality, compliance, and adherence to project requirements.
Installation Qualification	IQ	N/A
Insulation Resistance	IR	A measure of an insulator's ability to resist leakage currents.

Intended for Proposal	IFP	The drawing set used for permitting purposes (often 60%-90% complete).
Interconnect	IC	The term used to describe the connection between a site and utility power grid.
Interconnect Availability Date	IAD	The date on which interconnection with the electrical grid can occur with the utility provider.
Internal Rate of Return	IRR	The discount rate that makes the net present value (NPV) of all cash flows from a project equal to zero.
Inverter		Equipment which converts direct current (DC) into alternating current (AC), preparing the electricity generated by the solar panel for the power-grid and ultimately to be used to power appliances.
Investment Tax Credit	ITC	A federal tax incentive available to owners and contractors upon specific qualifications. Credit value can depend on political conditions at that time.
Issued for Construction	IFC	The drawing set was used during construction (100% complete).
Job Hazard Analysis	JHA	A tool used to identify how to perform a task step-by-step, any hazards associated with the task, and controls to mitigate the hazards.
Job Safety Analysis	JSA	A safety tool that can be used to define and control hazards associated with a certain process, job, or procedure.
Kickoff	Ko	The initiation of a project, recurring call, or initiative.
Large Generator Interconnect Agreement	LGIA	A variation of an interconnection agreement between utility and owner of the power generation facility.
Limit of Land Development	LLD	N/A
Limited Notice to Proceed	LNTP	A formal notice allowing limited inspections or testing on a project site.
Limits of Disturbance	LOD	The absolute boundaries of a project in which permitted activities can occur.
Liquidated Damages	LD's	Daily fine for missing a milestone deadline, typically Substantial Completion. Can also be tied to capacity and production depending on the Agreement. Value varies from project to project.

Lockout Tagout	LOTO	Program used to define the minimum requirement for the control of hazardous energy to prevent personal injury and equipment damage by ensuring all known sources of energy are isolated and potential energy is released or contained in a safe manner during work activities.
Main Power Transformer	MPT	N/A
Material Requisition Form	MRF	Technical specs that are required to place a PO for certain materials.
Mechanical Completion	MC	The site is physically complete. Posts, racking, modules, combiner boxes, and the PCS(s) are all installed. This is the first completion milestone and individual requirements are EPC-specific.
Medium Voltage Alternating Current	MV / MVAC	Medium voltage ranges between 1,000 to 35,000 volts (or 1kVac - 35 kVac).
Medium Voltage Feeder Cable	MVF	(AC Only) Interconnection wiring between PCS's and GSC's to POI's and/or Substations
Megawatt	MW	Equal to 1,000,000 watts.
Megger Testing	Megger	Method of testing making use of an insulation tester resistance meter that will help to verify the condition of electrical insulation (IR).
Membership Interest Purchase Agreement	MIPA	N/A
Micro-Inverter		A micro-inverter system has one inverter per panel which enables each panel to operate independently. Micro inverters typically have a longer lifespan than string inverters and can provide greater flexibility if you want to increase your system size at a later date. Whilst micro-inverters may therefore seem preferable, they are more expensive to install, create more points of failure and require more maintenance. It is often sufficient instead to have a sophisticated monitoring system which alerts you to problems in real-time so any under-performance can be rectified quickly.
Module Circuit	-	A subset of an array, a circuit is a series of modules connected to each other via whips and harnesses. The size of a circuit can be determined by engineering drawings, but typically consists of 24-27 modules, or 4-circuits per rack.

Motor Operated Air Brake	MOAB	A switch that is similar to a GOAB switch but is equipped with a motor that allows it to be operated remotely. Use: MOAB switches are ideal for locations where automation is preferred or where frequent switching is required. They enhance safety and save time by allowing the remote control of circuit isolation.
National Electric Testing Association	NETA	N/A
Net Present Value	NPW	Used capital budgeting to analyze profitability of an investment or project.
Network Operations Center	NOC	N/A
Notice of Funding Availability	NoFA	N/A
Notice of Intent	NOI	A formal notice aimed at initiating the commencement of an activity.
Notice to Proceed	NTP	A milestone indicating formal approval to begin construction or a key phase of a project.
Solar Panels	Modules (“Mods”)	The equipment responsible for converting sunlight into electrical current.
Operational	OP	As in Operational Test.
Operational Qualification	OQ	N/A
Operations and Maintenance	O&M	After the site is constructed and delivering power, it will be turned over to an O&M team responsible for handling warranty and ongoing maintenance.
Performance Qualification	PQ	N/A
Performance Test	PT	A test to determine that the output of the solar plant meets or exceeds the agreed-upon performance. Individual requirements are EPC-specific.
Permission to Energize	PTE	The formal approval required to energize electrical systems for testing or operation.
Personal Protective Equipment	PPE	Equipment worn to minimize employee's exposure to hazards.
Photovoltaic	PV	Method of generating electrical power by the conversion of solar energy into electricity.

Photovoltaic Connecting Switchgear	PVCS	Provides a means to shut off power leaving the solar plant and serves as a safety device.
Photovoltaic Interconnection Switchgear	PVIS	An isolated assortment of control equipment (I.e. switches) and protection devices a site may incorporate to protect the facility from the surrounding grid and/or substation.
Placed In Service	PIS	Typically, earlier than COD PIS aimed to clear for site readiness. PIS is not always a milestone and criteria is contract-specific when included.
Point of Contact	POC	Refers to the designated individual or entity for communication and coordination.
Point of Interconnect	POI	Where the power from the solar plant connects to the grid.
Power Conversion Station	PCS	In solar power plants, this is where power is converted from DC to AC. Components included in a PCS are the Inverter and Transformer.
Power Purchase Agreement	PPA	An arrangement in which a third-party developer installs, owns, and operates an energy system on a customer's property. The customer then purchases the system's electric output for a predetermined period.
Preliminary Site Plan	PSP	A draft site plan used for client approval, produced by the PDE.
Pressure Relief Valve	PRV	A mechanical component that is used to relieve pressure in a system.
Procore	-	DEPCOM's primary project management and execution tool capable of facilitating and tracking a variety of processes.
Project Development Engineering	PDE	The engineer that is responsible for performing various pre-design analyses.
Project Closeout Execution Plan	PCEP	A structured document and process that ensures all quality, compliance, business, and operational requirements are satisfied as a project completes.
Project Engineering Manager	PEM	Responsible for facilitating project design, subcontractor scopes of work, and managing project permits.
Project Execution Plan	PEP	A comprehensive document that outlines how a project will be executed, monitored and controlled
Project Manager or Preventative Measure	PM	Responsible for managing contracts, budgets, schedules, and leading discussions between DEPCOM and stakeholders.

Project Opportunity Profile	POP	A Project profile that covers every category and capabilities top level risks and opportunities to generate a depiction of the project in the form of a chart. This process starts at inception and updates throughout the project.
Punch List		An itemized list work either not yet completed per the scope and/or that does not conform to design criteria and must be completed in order to achieve a project milestone.
Purchase Order	PO	A document generated by the buyer to formalize a purchase agreement.
Purchase Request	PR	A request for procurement to purchase a certain quantity of materials or services, so they are available at a certain point.
Quality Assurance/Quality Control	QA/QC	The department that is responsible for ensuring (or process describing) that products meet specified quality standards.
Rack / Row / Tracker		A term used in the field and/or on a drawing set to define (1) independent set of racking components. Size and local definition of a Rack / Row / Tracker can be determined by engineering drawings.
Racking	-	The equipment used to mount solar panels. In utility-scaled solar, racking is typically “Ground Mounted” meaning the racking is mounted to piles (posts) embedded into the ground.
Recordable Incident Rate	RIR	The rate at which incidents occurred vs. the number of employees.
Recorded Environmental Condition	REC	These are determined during the first Environmental report.
Reliability Test	RT	N/A
Request for Information	RFI	A solicitation document that is used to obtain general information from suppliers about their products, services, and capabilities.
Request for Interpretation Information	RFI (alt)	A formal inquiry for clarification on construction plans or contract terms. (May include interpretation and clarification)
Request for Proposal	RFP	A business document that announces a project describes it and solicits proposals from suppliers.
Resource Protection Area	RPA	N/A

Risk and Opportunity Mitigation Plan	ROMP	A process and tool for capturing R&O from inception to LNTP with feedback from all capabilities.
Safety Data Sheet	SDS	A document defining the material makeup of a chemical or piece of equipment and indicating all related hazards.
Safety Data Sheet	SDS	Contains technical information about a chemical or material, including properties, hazards, and safe handling procedures.
Schedule of Values	SOV	A detailed schedule apportioning the original contract sum and all associated costs.
Scope of Authority	SOA	N/A
Scope of Work	SOW	The statement describes the work requirements of a job and all associated deliverables, actions, and timelines.
Selling, General and Administrative expenses	SG&A	Overhead costs are generally defined as operating expenses, whereas profit refers to the financial gain after accounting for costs.
Silt Fence	SF	Temporary sediment control devices used on construction sites to protect water quality in nearby streams, rivers, lakes, and seas from sediment in stormwater runoff.
Single Line Diagram	SLD	A drawing within the electrical engineering plans graphically representing the three-phased MV power layout within the powerplant. Drawings should include information of major electrical equipment, MV Cables, and where the plant connects to the grid and/or Substations.
Site Communications Center	SCC	N/A
Site Plan Approval Requisites	SPAR	Documents needed to produce a detailed PSP for approval to Site Plan. Often triggers many critical elements of design.
Site Quality Manager	SQM	DEPCOM Site Quality Manager – May be represented by a contract employee or DEPCOM team member with DEPCOM Senior Quality Manager Approval.
Special Use Permit	SUP	A permit authorizing use or activity under a predetermined list of requirements.

Standard Operating Procedure	SOP	A formal, written document that provides step-by-step instructions on how to perform a specific task or process within an organization.
Standard Racking	-	A ground-mounted racking style requiring relatively flat and even terrain. Standard racking can take the form of either Fixed Tilt or Tracker.
Storm Water Pollution Prevention Plan	SWPPP	A site-specific document signed by a project executive that identifies all activities and conditions at the site that could cause water pollution and details steps to prevent any unpermitted pollution.
String Inverter		The most common type of inverter. In this set-up, the solar panels are wired together through a common “string” and all energy produced is sent to a single inverter. String-based systems are easy to maintain and cheaper than other types but have the disadvantage that the system is only as good as the worst performing panel. However, if you are regularly monitoring your system’s output, this may not cause any problems. If your site is affected by shade, a micro inverter or power optimizer is preferable as it optimizes the system’s performance and ensures that one panel’s underperformance does not affect a whole string of panels.
String Wire	“TBD”	Interconnection between module and homerun’s
String Wire Jumper	DC Jumpers	Extends string wires to connect Conversion Jumpers to homeruns
Structured What If Techniques	SWIFT	A brainstorming and risk identification method to assess risk alternatives.
Subject Matter Expert	SME	an individual with deep knowledge, expertise, and specialized skills in a particular field, domain, or subject area. SMEs are recognized as authorities in their area of expertise and are often consulted for their insights, advice, and guidance on specific topics or projects.
Submittal		A process which requires approval or feedback on specific items, documents, reports, etc. A submittal often takes the form of a singular document or file consisting of multiple sheets. A submittal – approved or not – should ultimately be organized among other submittals of similar nature into “packages”. A submittal can either be requested or sent without prompt.

Substantial Completion	SC	The site is producing power to the grid. Individual requirements are EPC-specific. This milestone is usually tied to Liquidated Damages and follows COD.
Substation	Sub	A facility consisting of various medium and high voltage electrical equipment, responsible for safely increasing or decreasing the voltage from the powerplant to the power grid. These facilities are typically separate from the powerplant.
Supervisory Control & Data Acquisition	SCADA	Monitoring system of software and hardware elements that allows DEPCOM to control and monitor plant operations remotely and maintain maximum efficiency of a site.
Switchyard		An isolated area – which can either reside within a substation or be located separately – designed to protect the powerplant from the distribution grid and manage the voltage exchange between the two. A switchyard generally contains a variety of control equipment (I.e. switches) and protection devices.
Terrain Following Racking	-	A ground-mounted racking style designed to accommodate uneven or sloped land contours. Terrain Following systems can take the form of either Fixed Tilt or Tracker.
Time and Materials	T&M	Time and materials ("T&M") is a form of contract used to pay Contractors on a basis of how much time and materials used to perform a scope of work. This type of contract may be executed for undetermined duration of scope of work.
Topography	TOPO	A two-dimensional map communicating a third dimension, such as ground elevation.
Total Recordable Incident Rate	TRIR	The rate at which incidents occurred vs. the number of employees.
Tracker Racking System	TRKR, Txr	A ground mounted **racking style that moves** throughout the day to **follow the sun's path** across the sky, maximizing the amount of sunlight each panel receives.
Transformer	XFMR	Primarily used to step-up voltage to deliver renewable energy to the utility grid.
Transmittal		A formal, timestamped process employed to send (or "transmit") documents or deliverables. This process is accompanied by a standard cover letter with the deliverable attached. A Transmittal does

		not require approval but is simply a unidirectional exchange.
Unit of Measure	UOM	The unit in which associated values are measured.
Viewpoint for Projects	VFP	Website used for document storage and control.
Voltage Open Circuit	VOC	The voltage seen in a system with no electrical resistance.
Workers Environmental	WEAP	N/A
10th Percentile	P10	This means there is a 10% chance that the actual result will be less than or equal to this value. Represents a "low case" or optimistic scenario.
50th Percentile	P50	This is the "middle" or median scenario, meaning there's a 50% chance that the actual result will be less than or equal to this value. Most likely value.
90th Percentile	P90	There's a 90% chance that the actual result will be less than or equal to this value. Represents a "high case" or pessimistic scenario.

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00	**09/09/25**	**Initial Release**	**Gary Butzlaff**
01	**11/10/2025**	**Reviewed for cross-functional alignment**	**Gary Butzlaff**